PRODUCT CASE STUDY * AYUSH GOKUL

HAPPY FEET

Reducing *last mile delivery* friction for college students.

Problem Statement

In college campuses across India, students are not allowed to bring their own vehicles into campus. Students are often walking - HappyFeet allows students to monetize a walk they would be making regardless.

MIT Manipal alone has ~5000 students across campus, at a conservative 15% daily addressable demand that's 600 orders per day, on one campus.

Campus Delivery Inefficiency

Delivery apps like Swiggy, Zomato, Blinkit etc are not optimized for internal campus logistics.

Student Time Loss

Students spend significant times out of their days covering the distance of large campuses to collect food, parcels or essentials, disrupting schedules and reducing convenience.

Untapped Student Movement

Thousands of students already walk across campus daily, but there is no system that converts this system into an efficient peer to peer delivery network or income oppurtunity.

Lack of Hyperlocal Delivery Infrastructure

Most existing delivery platforms optimize for city wide logistics rather than short distance movement within densely populated campuses.

Understanding The Campus Delivery Environment

01 CONVENIENCE MATTERS MORE THAN SPEED

User research revealed that students cared less about ultra fast delivery and more about just not making that walk themselves.

02 COLLEGE CAMPUSES FUNCTION LIKE MICRO CITIES

Large campuses have their own movement patters, existing delivery systems are not designed to handle the complexity of internal campus logistics.

03 EXISTING MOVEMENT AS DELIVERY SUPPLY

The core idea was that students are already making these walks regardless, instead of creating a dedicated fleet we convert existing movement into delivery infrastructure.

This revealed that peer to peer campus delivery already exists informally. HappyFeet aims to structure and scale an existing behavioral pattern rather than introducing an entirely new process.

Results from survey conducted via google forms across 90 students from 15 different colleges.

TRUTH IS,

78%

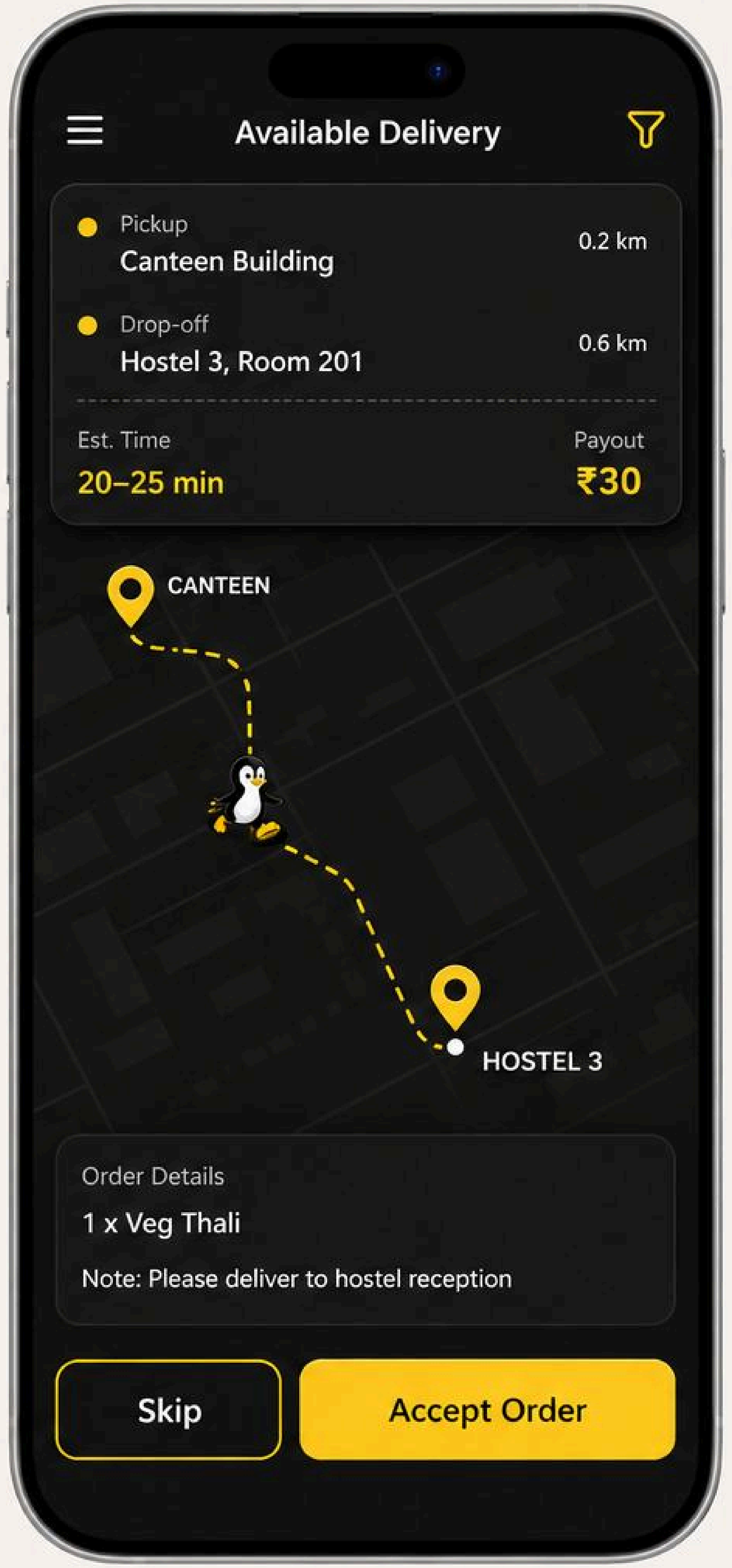
The percentage of students that have asked friends to fetch something for them

USER RESEARCH SAYS

87.8% of surveyed students said they would use a peer to peer delivery service.

Survey responses indicated a strong demand for a faster and more convenient way to receive food and essentials within campus environments, especially from verified student runners,

Introducing HappyFeet



Enabling students to request and complete short distance deliveries inside college campuses through a trusted peer network.

AYUSH GOKUL

How HappyFeet Works

A simple 5 step journey from request to delivery.

Early Product Priorities

The MVP focuses on validating adoption and reliability before expanding into advanced features.

01 TRUST AND VERIFICATION

From the conducted user research we learned that trust is a major factor that peer to peer delivery depends on. Verified student identities prioritized to increase safety and trust.

02 LOCATION CLARITY

Pickup and drop off details prioritized to reduce coordination overhead and make new runners comfortable with campus environments in different areas.

03 FLEXIBLE TIMINGS

From the user research we also learned that students would do this in their free time to make a quick penny. There are no fixed timings or any dedicated delivery commitments - full freedom to accept or deny.

DECISIONS AND TRADEOFFS

Pricing

Fixed vs User Set Pricing
User Set pricing sounds flexible but creates negotiation friction right at the moment of matching. A runner will see a low offer and skip it adding a supply problem before launch. Fixed zone pricing keeps it simple, runners know payment upfront. Less flexible but making deliveries actually happen matters more than pricing perfection at the MVP.

Payments

Off Platform vs Escrow
Escrow is cleaner on paper but requires payment infra and compliance standards to adhere to. Cash and Gpay off platform gets users and validation faster. Trust risk is already partially covered through verified ID’s and ratings system. Escrow is the obvious path forward once volume justifies it.

Unit Economics of HappyFeet

HappyFeet was designed to solve 2 problems - making campus errands convenient and providing flexible earning oppurtunities for students already walking across campus.

₹30	Average Delivery Fee Per Order
₹20	Average Payout to Runner
₹10	Estimated Platform Revenue
0	Dedicated Delivery Fleet Required

NORTH STAR : ORDERS COMPLETED PER DAY ON CAMPUS

This single number tells us whether both sides of the network are active and the core behavior is working. MVP is validated when we hit 20+ orders per day consistently.

Activation

20+ carriers complete their first delivery in month one.

80+ requesters place their first order in month one.

Reliability

Order completion rate > 85%

Average delivery time under 30 minutes.

Retention

25% percent of requesters place a second order within 2 weeks.

30% of carriers accept 3+ deliveries in their first month.

Challenges & Risks

01 PLATFORM BYPASS RISK

Users could potentially exchange contacts and complete future deliveries outside the platform.

Mitigated by keeping value inside the app - ratings, delivery history and eventually in app payments.

02 TRUST & LIABILITY

Handling parcels introduces the accountability challenges around lost and damaged deliveries.

Capped liability per order with clear terms and conditions upon signup. OTP and Photo confirmation creates paper trail, disputes handles through in app reporting before any escalation.

03 SEASONAL DEMAND

Campus activity and delivery volume takes a massive hit during semester breaks, holidays and long weekends.

Accepted as a structural reality of campus products. Focus retention efforts on the academic calendar and treat breaks as low cost periods to iterate and work on things that might require the app to be shut down.

04 SCALING ACROSS CAMPUSES

Different colleges operate with unique layouts, rules, restrictions making standardization difficult.

Each campus onboarded manually with a student ambassador who maps zones and local rules before launch. Standardize product, localize operations.

WHAT'S NEXT FOR HAPPYFEET?

CAMPUS STORE INTEGRATIONS

HappyFeet could integrate directly with campus stores, canteens and pharmacies to streamline internal campus deliveries.

DELIVERY BATCHING

As order density increases, multiple deliveries along similar routes could be grouped together to improve efficiency.

EXTERNAL DELIVERY PARTNERSHIPS

The platform could potentially function as the final campus delivery layer for services like Swiggy and Zomato, helping solve last mile delivery logistics.

KEY LEARNINGS

Users Value Convenience

Students prioritized reducing effort and unnecessary walking over ultra fast delivery.

Existing Behavior Is Easier To Scale

Students were already informally asking friends to collect items, validating the behavior behind HappyFeet.

Operational Challenges Matter Most

The biggest challenges are not technical, but rather operational - balancing trust, consistency and coordination.

BUILDING HAPPYFEET TAUGHT ME THAT THE STRONGEST PRODUCTS CAPITALIZE ON BEHAVIOR THAT ALREADY EXISTS

It also explored how campus logistics is not a technological bottleneck - it’s a behavioral and operational problem.